

capture these changes relative to the launch of ChatGPT. By December 2024, adopters have increased their hours in their most recent occupation by about 4% of a full-time equivalent relative to non-adopters. The figure provides four insights.

First, the figure suggests that chatbots appeal to workers who are new to their occupations. This relationship may reflect that chatbots facilitate occupational transitions—for instance, by granting access to otherwise scarce expertise—or that workers who have recently switched find chatbots especially valuable as they adapt to new roles.¹⁷

Second, the effects on occupational mobility grow steadily, likely reflecting both the deepening of adoption over time and the emergence of new labor market opportunities. As we show below, these transitions tend to be into occupations with higher wage premia and greater AI chatbot relevance, suggesting that this mobility channel may gain importance over time.

Third, the flat pre-trend prior to the arrival of chatbots suggests that this association reflects a real effect rather than omitted confounders (e.g., more dynamic workers both adopting chatbots and switching jobs more generally). This contrasts with the earnings gaps in Panel (a), which were entirely attributable to pre-existing differences between adopters and non-adopters.

Finally, the significant estimates provide reassurance that our empirical specification has the power to detect effects when they exist—a useful contrast to the null results for earnings and employment.

Heterogeneity by Intensity of Adoption. Figure 6, Panel (b) examines how the relationship between chatbot adoption and occupational mobility varies with the intensity of adoption. The figure shows that the association between chatbot adoption and occupational switching is driven primarily by individual-level factors rather than firm-level initiatives. For example, our main estimate on occupational switching rises from 1.3%

¹⁷In contrast, Appendix F.3 shows that the association between chatbot adoption and workplace mobility is weaker, and occupational mobility is no stronger at workplaces that encourage chatbot use. These patterns align with Figure 6, Panel (b), which indicates that the relationship between chatbot adoption and occupational switching is driven primarily by individual rather than firm-level factors.

to 4.1% for individuals who use the tools daily, and to 4.0% for those who report large time savings.¹⁸ By contrast, the relationship between adoption and occupation switching is fairly similar across employer chatbot initiatives, ranging in 2024 from about 1.1% to 1.9% across initiatives.

Occupational Heterogeneity. Figure 7, Panel (b), splits the effects of chatbot adoption on mobility by survey occupation.¹⁹ Positive effects appear in multiple occupations, but are strongest and most statistically significant among IT supporters, and to some extent, office clerks. These are occupations where individual workers likely have more flexibility in choosing their toolset, allowing newcomers to take advantage of AI chatbots. In contrast, financial advisors and customer support specialists often work with established IT systems, making it harder for newcomers to compensate for missing skills by using chatbots on an individual basis. These patterns align with Dillon et al. (2025), who show that workers primarily adopt Microsoft Copilot for tasks where they can use the tools without coordinating with others. Finally, the absence of switching effects in licensed occupations—such as teachers and accountants, which require several years of prior education—strengthens the interpretation that the mobility effects observed elsewhere reflect a genuine link between chatbot use and newcomers acquiring occupation-relevant skills.

Job Characteristics for Adopters Who Switch Occupations. Adopters who switch occupations are particularly informative for two reasons. First, occupational switching is the only administrative outcome that moves with workers’ chatbot adoption. Second, since job switching is a core source of labor market progression, the characteristics of these

¹⁸The effect magnitudes in Figure 6, Panel (b) are generally smaller than the endline estimates in Figure 5, Panel (c). This reflects that the pooled specifications estimate trends over the full sample period, absorbing part of the post-period treatment variation (see Equation (3)).

¹⁹Because survey respondents, by construction, are employed in the survey occupations at the time of sampling (June 2024), the worker-level adoption analysis is primarily suited for studying occupational switching *into* these occupations. In Section 3.4, we examine potential displacement effects *out of* the survey occupations by studying incumbent workers—those employed in the survey occupations prior to the arrival of AI chatbots—based on their employers’ subsequent adoption of the tools.

switchers may serve as early indicators of the longer-run impacts of AI chatbots (Kleven et al., 2025). To understand what occupational mobility means for adopters, Table 2 compares the characteristics of origin and destination jobs for these switchers, measured in November 2022 and December 2024, respectively.

Adopters who switch occupations see 12 percentage points faster earnings growth between November 2022 and December 2024 relative to other Danish workers employed in both months. These switchers move into occupations with higher wage premia—rising from 0.46 to 0.53 standard deviations above the economy average, contributing a 3 percentage point boost to earnings growth. Even though these workers already come from occupations with above-average exposure to AI chatbots (0.92 standard deviations above the economy average, as measured by Eloundou et al. (2024)), they switch into occupations with 0.16 standard deviations higher exposure. In other words, adopters who switch occupations tend to move into ones where using AI chatbots is more relevant and where wages are higher—consistent with workers leveraging AI chatbots to access better-paying roles.

Discussion. A consistent finding from experimental studies is that AI chatbots provide greater productivity benefits to workers with less prior expertise in their occupations (Brynjolfsson, Li and Raymond, 2025; Dell’Acqua et al., 2024; Noy and Zhang, 2023). This section presents evidence supporting a key implication of those studies: chatbot adoption is associated with occupational switching, and adopters who switch move into occupations with higher wage premia and where using AI chatbots is more relevant. This is consistent with the thesis of Autor (2024) that generative AI helps workers expand into new work by granting access to otherwise scarce expertise. Indeed, actual usage data from chatbot developers show that *information seeking* and *practical guidance* are among the most common tasks workers use chatbots for (Chatterji et al., 2025)—precisely the kinds of tasks where lack of prior expertise could otherwise be a barrier.

Occupational mobility is thus the one margin where the rapid currents of AI adoption break through to administrative labor market outcomes. While these switchers remain too few to move average adopter earnings, the substantial gains for those who do switch

suggest a channel through which AI chatbots may deliver broader earnings effects as adoption deepens (Kleven et al., 2025).

3.4 Workplace Employment

Concerns have been raised that generative AI is already displacing workers, particularly those early in their careers. Indeed, Appendix D.2 documents aggregate declines in early-career employment in several of our exposed occupations in Denmark, mirroring patterns documented in the United States (Brynjolfsson, Chandar and Chen, 2025). A key advantage of our data, however, is that we can split these employment trends by whether firms have actually adopted generative AI.

Panel (a) shows that workplaces encouraging chatbot use have seen no differential change in total hours after the arrival of AI chatbots.²⁰ Our estimates are precise, ruling out effects larger than 2%.

Crucially, Panel (b) shows that the decline in early-career jobs is not driven by firms adopting AI chatbots. Difference-in-differences estimates show no differential changes in the employment share of early-career workers at adopting workplaces, with estimates precise enough to rule out effects greater than a third of a percentage point. These bounds imply that AI adoption can account for at most a small fraction of the aggregate declines in early-career employment documented in Appendix D.2—declines whose connection to generative AI is itself debated (Frank et al., 2026; Iscenko and Curto Millet, 2026).²¹

Beyond levels of employment, AI chatbots may alter the composition of labor demand. Even with constant employment levels, adopting and operating new tools may require workers with different skills, leading firms to hire new workers at the expense of incumbents (Bessen et al., 2023). At the same time, assistance from AI chatbots could instead help retain workers (Brynjolfsson, Li and Raymond, 2025).

²⁰Appendix F.4 shows that wage bills are similarly flat.

²¹About 43% of workplaces encourage chatbot use (Figure 1). Even if all encouraged workplaces experienced the largest decline consistent with our confidence intervals, chatbots would account for at most a $0.43 \times 0.33 \approx 0.14$ percentage point decline in the aggregate early-career share—small relative to the baseline share of about 8% (Table D.1) and the aggregate decline of about 0.6 percentage points between October 2022 and December 2024 implied by Figure D.2.